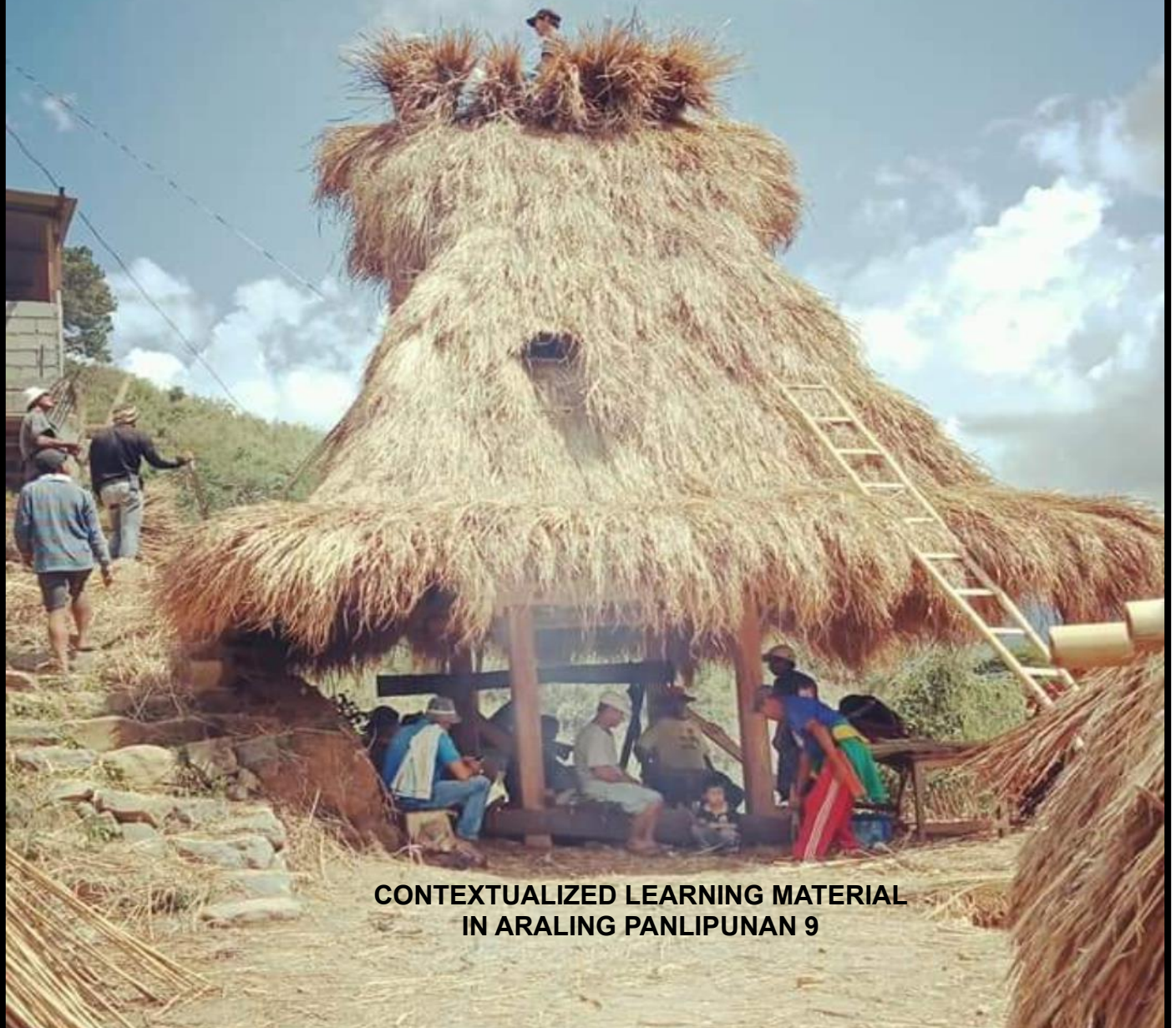


**AGRICULTURAL PRACTICES OF BALAOA,
TADIAN, MOUNTAIN PROVINCE:
A COMPILATION OF CHANTS**



**CONTEXTUALIZED LEARNING MATERIAL
IN ARLING PANLIPUNAN 9**

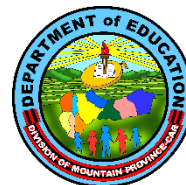


Developed:

JONETH C. BALAG-AY



Republic of the Philippines
DEPARTMENT OF EDUCATION
Cordillera Administrative Region
SCHOOLS DIVISION OF MOUNTAIN PROVINCE



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PREFACE

This Learning Material is a project of the Curriculum Implementation Division particularly the Learning Resource Management and Development Unit, Department of Education, Schools Division of Mountain Province which is in response to the implementation of the K-12 Curriculum.

This Learning Material is a property of the Department of Education-CID, Schools Division of Mountain Province. It aims to improve students' performance specifically on the Mother Tongue based-Multi Lingual Education.

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For MOTHER TONGUE LMS: Indigenous Cultural Community (ICC): e.g. Kankana-ey – Tadian (specify your vernacular)	Kankanaey –Tadian
Copyright Year	2019

Indicators for the Contextualization of the Instructional Material

Pamantayang Pangnilalaman: Naipamamalas ng mag-aaral ang pag-unawa sa mga sector ng ekonomiya at mga patakarang ekonomiya nito sa harap ng mga hamon at puwersa tungo sa pambansang pagsulong at pag-unlad.
Pamantayan sa Pagganap: Ang mga mag-aaral ay aktibong nakikibahagi sa maayos na pagpapatupad at pagpapabuti ng mga sector ng ekonomiya nito sa pambansang pagsulong at pag-unlad.
Kasanayang Pampagkatuto: 1. Nasusuri ang bahaging ginagampanan ng agrikultura at Paggugubat sa ekonomiya ng bansa at sa Barangay Balaoa (AP9SNA-IVc-4). 2. Nasusuri ang mga dahilan at epekto ng suliranin ng sector ng agrikultura at paggugubat sa bawat Pilipino at sa sariling lupaing ninuno (AP9SNA-IVa-2).
Detalyadong Kasanayang Pampagkatuto/Focus Skills: 1. Napahahalagahan ang mga IKSP ng sariling lugar na may kinalaman sa agrikultura at ang bahaging ginampanan nito sa pag-angat ng kabuhayan ng bawat mamamayan 2. Nakikibahagi sa mga programang pang-agrikultura sa sariling lugar.
Pamamahagi ng Oras/Timeline (Quarter/Week) Ikaapat na Markahan – Ikatlong Linggo

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**CONTEXTUALIZED LEARNING MATERIAL
IN ARALING PANLIPUNAN FOR GRADE 9**

Developed:

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Introduction

With the implementation of the K to 12 curricula, teachers are mandated to inculcate Indigenous Knowledge Systems and Practices (IKSPs) in all subject areas using the different approaches designed by the Department of Education.

The Department of Education, Division of Mountain Province recognizes the community's IKSPs and commits to maintaining the ancestral domain where the IKSP holders have lived long time and where their primary learning environments are located. Instructions in the Mountain Province Indigenous education have the following features:

- a. Teachers are researchers of Indigenous Peoples culture or are Ancestral domain-oriented and culture sensitive.
- b. The teaching-learning process utilizes the formal and informal way of learning and teaching.
- c. Strategies of teaching include indigenous ways as "learning by doing" like observation, application and developing IKSPs in real life situation.
- d. Teaching-learning process include the use of local resources and the ancestral-domain itself.
- e. Learner is sensitive to self-development/self-realization for a better community development.
- f. Elders are models for the young to emulate and are duty-bound teachers of Indigenous Knowledge Systems and Practices.

During the latest IPED Training of teachers on October 2016, there were two identified IKSPs to be used in contextualizing the curriculum. These are agricultural cycle and Human life stages. In connection to this, *Begnas* was held on this month, an opportunity for the developer of this material to interview. She was inspired to conduct interviews about the agricultural cycle. The interview was done after the rituals.

This material about the Agricultural Practices of Barangay Balaoa is suited in the contextualization of the lessons in my Araling Panlipunan and Edukasyon sa Pagpapakatao Subjects which defined and discussed with examples. Some of the prayers which are chanted during the rituals are reflected in this material.

Agricultural Practices of Barangay Balaoa, Tadian Mountain Province: A Compilation of Chants

Agriculture is the main source of living of our ancestors. They were the early developers of these agricultural practices which has been passed from generation to generation up to this present time. Barangay Balaoa is one of the Barangays of the municipality of Tadian who still observe the said agricultural practices. Embodied in these practices are the various rituals that our old folks had to perform. In the olden times, the community celebrates the *begnas* twice a year, before the planting season and after the harvest season. The planting and sowing of crops, seeds, and trees are coordinated according to the phases of the moon. Most of the planting of crops is believed to be productive during the different stages of the moon while the absence of the moon is believed to be non-productive. Today, the people of Balaoa celebrate their *Begnas* usually before the planting season of the *sama di igorot* which usually starts on the month of October onwards and after the harvest season of the rice crops which was planted during the *pak-ang* season that was usually harvested on the month of June onwards. *Begnas* celebration is a way of thanking and entreating the ancestors and the gods for a good and abundant harvest. This fact is very much manifested on the ritual prayers which the elder's chants during each ritual ceremony.

Cycles in the Agricultural Practice

A. Land and Seedbed Preparation

Before the community prepares their land and seedbed, the old folks (*panglakayen*) performs the merriest feast in the community, the *Begnas*. This was observed when the *Kesep* is finished and before preparing the land where the seeds are to be sown. The following are the *Begnas* rituals to be observed:

1. ID-IDEW. This is the first ritual to be observed by the community elders accompanied by butchering an appropriate material considering the good bile sac or *Pidis*. The good bile sac will give the go signal for the elders to look for *labeg* at dawn.

During the ritual, the elders will require a *kawitan* that is healthy with no physical defect. The elders believed that the rooster will chase away bad luck that will come in the community to inflict illness to the people. As long as the *kawitan* is physically perfect, it is an ideal offering regardless of its colors, its weight, its age, or its breed. According to the elders, the offering should be a *kawitan* and not a hen because this is what the elders have been using before. The offering will be cooked with the usual

utensils such as casserole, the spoon among others. It will be cooked over the firewood prepared by the elders before the ritual was conducted.

The ritual usually begins at around 8:00 to 9:00 o'clock in the evening at the main *at-atoan at Gawa*. The elder who was appointed to hold the *Begnas* will chant this prayer:

Kankanaey Version

English Translation

<i>Dakayo ay inmun-una ed nabaon,</i>	Our Ancestors, it was your practice that
<i>say inyaat yo ay no mangid-idew</i>	if you perform this id-idew ritual, you
<i>kayo et ekarkaragyo. Et say</i>	have to pray. This is the reason why you
<i>sinumyaanyo, say naganakan yo si</i>	prospered in life, was blessed with
<i>babae ya lalaki, say insuwerte yo si</i>	children, had abundance, have jobs and
<i>insama yo, ubla ya adal. Nay</i>	your children got educated. We are
<i>mangid-idew kami abe et say umat</i>	doing this ritual so that it will happen to
<i>kendakami. Mabuyag nan men-ili.</i>	us also. Bless all the people in the
	community.



Fig. 1 Balag-ay, Joneth C., personal photograph, "The Elders Performing the Id-idew ritual at Gawa at-Atoan," March 2017.



Fig. 2 Balag-ay, Joneth C., personal photograph, "The Elders Performing the Id-idew Ritual at Gawa at-Atoan," March 2017.

When the leader finished chanting the prayer, they will butcher the *kawitan* and inspect its bile sac. The bile sac has various types and meanings. If the bile sac is *simlit*, it means good because the elders believed that those who are seeking jobs can be easily employed. But if the bile sac is *delway*, the elders will require another *kawitan* until they find a *simlit* bile sac. The *delway* is not good because it is believed that if the children will harvest their *palay*, it will not be enough to sustain them and when they get employed, their salaries will not be enough to meet their needs. If the bile sac is *kopis*, the elders will require another sacrificial chicken depending on how the *kopis* looks like. If the bile sac does not contain any liquid, they will require a *mamasang*. They believed that when a *mamasang* is offered the blessings will go to the children in their quest of finishing college courses, seeking job, buying properties, and in making their life status better. If the bile sac protruded a little, the elders will require an *obo-an*. The elders believed also that when an *obo-an* is offered, the good fortune will stay longer in the family and it can be inherited by future children. If the bile sac satisfied the ritual leader, they will cook the meat. When the meat is already cooked, the elders who were gathered during the ritual will distribute the seven different ritual prayers among themselves. The chanting of these prayers will be done simultaneously. These prayers are namely: *Loto*, *Mendasay*, *Binmawi*, *Inmey Nen-paitdo ken Agew*, *Mangili-en*, *Nandosdos*, and *Legleg*. The elders who was appointed to hold the *Begnas* will chant the *Loto* prayer while other elders chant the other prayers as follows:

Sapon di Loto

Wada kanu nan apon di itanap ay no dayda san mangid-idew asi dapay sapo-en nan loto. Et dayda nan maubanan ya siya nan maad adoan di ipugaw, et siya nan lumang-ayan da. Umat abe isnan isama da et mabgas. Asi dapy pasa-a-en isnan ili et siya nan mangikam-kaman et mangid-idew da et siya nan sinomyaan da.

Loto Prayer

There was once an elder from the plain who performed the *id-idew* prayer and chanted this *Loto* prayer. This is the reason why they lived long lives, became rich, and their people grew in number. Even their plants bear much fruits. When they taught this ritual to the community and the people followed their example their lives progressed as well.

Sapon di Mendasay

Wada kanu nan sin-agi ay mansama. Mo kano ya man-apit da, pon-en da nan gamang da ya kamarin da yan maid kanon kakanan na. Asi da et pay mangid-idew, asi-et mamegnas da. Siya nan sinmika-an nan insama da et say somobra nan insama da. Asi da pay papaytoken sinan ili et say ikaman da.

Mendasay Prayer

There were two brothers who tend their rice field. When they harvested their palay, they filled their rice granary to the full. But it was not enough for their consumption. When they performed the *id-idew* ritual and the *Begnas* is celebrated, their harvest on the next harvest season became sufficient and abundant. Then they taught this ritual in our community and we followed their example.

Sapon di Binmawi

Nan kano sin-agi, no bomala da et no waday makilang-ayan da yan no idawat da nan apag da ya natogpaan. No idawat da pay abe nan kisda da pay ya ikappos da ona isnan tenged da asida pay pagosaden sinan adpa da. "Ay sino pay nan kaipogaw tas na ta enta et adin bumawi," kano kano nan sin-agi. Asi da et sapo-en nan bawi da.

Binmawi Prayer

There were two brothers who usually attend a party. The people spit on their portion of rice before it is given to them, the people will wipe it first on their neck then down to their hands. "Why do people treat us this way? Let us get even with them," The two brothers told themselves. So, the two brothers prepared to build a hut. They got tiger grass to make their head caps

Ala-en da nan maanaaw et sapoen da si abistong. Mangabilaw ta kad ta ilan ta no waday omali si mangi-on-onod si kedsena ken daitas na,” kanan da kano. Asi da et mangabilaw kano yan wada tet-ewa nan mangisalsalik si tadek na isnan oson di bawi da. Asi et ibaan nan iyun-a nan iyugtan ta ena ilan yaket ilana nan manmanok ay labey. “Ay sa kad ta kasin tan mangabilaw no sino nan kasin omalis sa,” kanan da kano. Asi da pay mangabilaw yan kasin dumateng nan mangisalsalik si tadek nan sinan oson di bawi da. Bomala kasin san iyugtan yan inila nan tala ay tinmayaw. “Ay sa kad ta appisan ta nan bobong di bawi ta, waay kasin umali isa,” kanan da kasin. Asi da pay appisan nan bobong di bawi da et mangabilaw da. Yaket dumateng kano nan maikolisawan nan sikin di ipogaw. Mapika et kanu nan iyun-a et depapena nan sikin di naikolisawan adey. “Alaem et nan banig ta potilan ta nan sikin di ipogaw ay mangi-on-onod si kedse na ken daita,” kanan kano nan iyun-a. “Ay, adi yo tet-ewa da-dam-en,” kinwanin nan si Lumawig tay kumbaw sisya obpay kano di. “Ta manleteg ak ta mantey-teya tako,” kanan Lumawig. Et dey kanu manleteg et mantey-teya da. “Sino pay san begew ay umali kayo

also. “Let us built a hut and wait for someone who is mean to us,” they said. While they were busy building their hut, there came a thumping foot on the roof of their hut. The older brother sent his younger brother to check on it and he saw a bird called *labey*. “Let us continue our work and wait for that someone who is thumping his feet on our roof,” they said. So, they set on their work again then they heard the thumping feet on their roof. The younger brother went out to check who it is but he saw a *tala* flying away. “Let us uncover some part of our roof. Maybe that thumping feet will come back again,” said the two brothers. So, they uncovered some part of their roof and then went back to their work. Then the thumping of feet came again and fell on the uncovered part of the roof accidentally. Quickly, the older brother stood up and caught the foot that is hanging on their roof and ordered his brother to give him the *bolo* so that he will cut off that foot. “Don’t do such things”, Lumawig interrupted. “Let me stand up and let’s have a talk”, he said. So Lumawig got down from the roof and asked the two brothers, “Why are you building this hut?” “We are doing this because whenever we go to a party, the people will spit on our portion of rice. Before our portion of meat will reach us, the people will wipe it first on their neck and then down their hands. So,

isnan segpan ya sapo-en yo san bawi yo et dey mangabilaw kayo,” kanan Lumawig. “Adi kayman si no bumala kami ta waday makilang-ayan mi ya ikappos da ona isnan tenged da asi da pay pagosaden isnan adpa da nan watwat ya kisda ay ited da ken dakami. Ay sino pay nan kaipogaw ta sina kanan mis nan awak mi” kinwani da kano. Baken sumaa kayo ta asi kayo pay alan nan manok ay kawitan ya mangid-idew kayo. Asi kayo pay isapo nan binmawi ta dakayo et san manapat sinan ili. Suma-a da pay et inala da nan kawitan et mangid-idew da yaket tet-ewa kano ay dayda nan mawiswisingan sinan ili ya mansodsod-sodan di kaipo-ipogaw. “Agyod obpay kayman na,” kinwanin nan sin-agi. Asi da pay ibala isnan ili ay mapat-a ta dayda di man-isuro isnan sapon di binmawi. Bomala da et payongan da ed Kawitan yan siya nan ili ay mapat-a. Papaytoken da ed Kawitan at dawaten di apon di Kawitan. Dayda di saya mangid-idew yaket siya nan somya-an di soadan da. Asida pay iyagadang isnan ili ay odom. Mendaddad-an da et laosan da ed Bauko ya ed Tabeyo, asida et papaytoken ed Balaoa et dayda di saya mangid-idew yaket siya nan mabgasan di isama da, sumya-an ya maobanan

we asked ourselves why people treat us this way,” they explained. “Go home, get a rooster and do the *id-idew* ritual so that you will have good luck. People will hear you speak and you will be respected,” Lumawig advised them. So, the two brothers went home and did as they were told to do. The words of Lumawig come to pass because they were indeed given good luck. People will go to them for advice and counselling. “This is really good,” observed the two brothers. They thought of teaching it to other people so they went down to *Kawitan* to teach the ritual. When the people of *Kawitan* did the *id-idew* ritual, they received good luck. Their animals grew in number. Then the community of Balaoa did the *id-idew* ritual, their plants bore much more. The two brothers went to other places like Bauko, Tabeyo and then down to Balaoa. When they harvest, they are blessed, lived long lives, and grew in number.

da. Et siya nan naad-adu-an da ay ipogaw.

Sapon di Inmey Nenpaitdo Ken

Agew

Wda kano nan mensin-agi ay maipipitapit di kababaiyan da. Asida et nemnemen ay umey ken Agew at ununen da nan palidang ay naiwawaned at mentikid ed tongdo. Sida et kano datngan nan si asawan Agew ay si Dada ay men-ab-abe kano. "Apay say maid lomlombot si ipugaw yan dakayo nan dinmateng isa," kanan kano nan asawan Agew sinan sin-agi. "Adi tay inmali kami ay menpaitdo no waday itdo da si iyat mi isnan kababaiyan mi," kanan nan sin-agi. "Ay, siya man sa," kanan Dada kano et tang-tangena nan agamang di dao ta no sumaa nan si Agew ya adi na dangdangen nan sin-agi. Anggay pay kano ay maboyogan nan Aew et omooto-an yan sana tetewa ay dumateng kanu si Agew. "Apay sa ken Kaman waday songsongek si teken di kaipogaw na ay inmalisna," kanan kanon Agew. Nay wada man nan sin-agi kano ay ta manpaitdos iyat da tay nan kababaiyan da et anggay ay maipipitapit kano," insungbat Dada. Ay siya, kad alaem nan laey ko ay sinamawan at sakebam nan sin-agi asika pay ibala dayda," kanan kanon Agew. Alan

Inmey Nenpaitdo Ken Agew Prayer

There were two brothers who had a bedridden sister. They thought of going to Agew (Sun) to seek for counsel so they took a straight way going skyward. Then they found Agew's wife, dada, who is busy weaving. "Why did you come here? Nobody has ever dared to come here except you", asked the surprised woman. "We have come here to inquire on what we are going to do with our bedridden sister", the two brothers replied. "Is that so?", answered Dada and she hid them on the granary so that if Agew come home, he will not burn them alive. When the sun begun to settle down, Agew came home. "why do I smell other kind of people here?" inquired Agew. "There were two brothers who came here to inquire on what they will do with their bedridden sister," explained Dada. "Is that so? Cover them with my blanket and present them to em," Agew requested to his wife. Dada did what she was instructed and presented the two brothers to him. "Why did you come here? Nobody has ever dared to come here except you," inquired Agew. "We have come to inquire about our problem. All our chickens and pigs were sold to medicate our sister and yet she remained bedridden," they

et kanon Dada nan laey Agew ay sinam-awan at sakebana nan sin-agi asina pay ibala dayda. "Sino pay nan inmalian yo. Nay magay lomlombot si ipugaw isna yan dakayo san nilombot mo," kanan kanon Agew. "Siya man adi na ay problema mi nan inmalian mi. nay anggay naikupag nan biki ya nan baliw-a mi si eset di kababaiyan mi dapay kapikapiyana man adi sisya," insungbat nan sin-agi. "Mo tet-ewa kayo ay umali kayo menpaitdo, kumab kayos nan momma adey," kanan kanon Agew. Pakabena kano nan sin-agi isnan moma et kinummab da." Ay mendagem ka ta maila kad. No tet-ewa ay menpa-itdo danay et adi dan katekdag," kanan Agew. Mendagem kano et iwasawas na daida yan adida katekdag et asina papaytoken dayda. "Anggay siya ta sumaa kayo. Alaen yo san kawitan ta mangid-idew kayo. Yaken et siya tet-ewa nan matgo-an yo, tumingninan yo, ya maganakan yo," kanan kanon Agew. Siya kano ay sumaa da et alaen dan kawitan et mangid-idew da asida isapo nan Nenpaitdo ken Agew anay et tet-ewa kano ay naagasan ya natago et kanu nan kababaiyan da. Siya nan naad-adoan da, siya nan naobananda yan anggay ay mabgas at nan isama da. Asida et ibala isnan ili etno wada kano

explained. "If you have really come here to inquire, you climb that betel nut tree," ordered Agew. So, the two brothers did what they were asked to do. "Wind, blow them off. If they will not fall down from that momma tree then it is true that they have come to seek my help," prayed Agew. Then the wind blew hard and bends the betel nut tree sideways but the two brothers held fast on to the tree that they did not fell on the ground. Then, Agew let them down from the tree. "Go home, get a rooster and perform the id-idew ritual. This will make you live longer, give you good fortune, and give you many children," agew told them. So, the two brothers went home and did as they were told to. Agew's word came to pass because their sister was healed and lived a longer life. They had children, and have lived a longer life. They got children, and have lived a long lives. They got children, and have lived longer lives. Even their plants bear much fruit. Then the two brothers taught this to the community of Kawitan who followed their example also. This is the reason why they lived longer. The two brothers also taught this at Tabeyo and then down to Balaoa. Now we are doing this ritual.

*di mangid-idew yan masurot din Inmey
Nenpaitdo ken Agew. Ibala da abe ed
mapat-a et ipaytok da ed Kawitan et
dawaten di apon di Kawitan et mangid-
idew da. Yan siya et san maobanan da,
matagowan da, ya maganakan da.
Asida pay pasaaen ed Tabeyo et
pagusaden da ed Balaoa et nay
mangid-idew da.*

Sapon di Legleg

*Wada kanu nan sin-agi ay nanguma.
“ta enta kad manguma ta waday eskan
ta si kataguan ta,” kano kano nan
iyun-a. Inmey da pay kano isnan
naibilgana yan, “Ta enta et umaan nan
naiday-ukan adey ta mo waday
dumateng si dagem ya adi na igalid
nan isama ta,” kano nan iyun-a. Asida
et kano umaan nan sinkaday-ukan.
Maango pay kano nan inumaan da yan
maagawan et nan iyugtan et men-anap
si danum si inumena. Umey kano isnan
kad-an di ketang yan datngena nan
danum yakat anggay kadepa-depag
nan nigay ay wading ya lames sisi.
Tangadena pay nan kaiw ay sag-ena
yaket binumgas. “Ay siya ubpay nan
naga isnan natoba-an ay nigay ay nay,”
kano kano. Umey nat isodsod isnan
iyun-ana. Kinwani kanon iyun-ana.
Kinwani kanon iyun-ana, “Ay siya, enta
et adi omongen nan nigay ana ta*

Legleg Prayer

There were once two brothers who went farming. “Let us farm so that we will have something to eat,” the older brother said. Then they went on the hills to look for a good site and they found a spot below the hills. “Let us farm down there so that when the wind blows, it will not push down our plants,” the older brother said. So, the two brothers set to work on the site which they have selected. When the weeds which they pulled out have dried out, they burned it. Then the younger brother became thirsty and he began to look for water. Soon he reached the creek where he found the water but he discovered dead fishes such as *wading* and the *lames* along the creek. He looked up and saw a tree having many fruits. “Maybe this tree poisoned these fishes,” he said to himself. He went to his brother and informed him about his discovery. “Is that so? Come, let us gather those fishes and cook for our lunch,” the

otomen ta ta pamangan ta isnan baon ta." Enda et kano omongen asi da pay alan nan tobon di bila-bila et ibongan da. Asi da pay ipo-o isnan gawan di saket. Anggay pay ay ma-oto et alan da ta mangan da et ipangan da nan nigay da. Makakan da pay kano et kinwanin nan iyun-a, "Ay ken ya waday agyod et san toba aydey ta enta et ala-en nan tobo ya begas na." Asi da et en ala-en kano nan begas na ya tobon di kaiw et inyey da isnan dakdake ay ginawang ta say maammo nan alana ay nigay kano. Waay asida pay goyoden adi ya iyolnos da yan kadepadepag et kano nan nigay. Mas-at et kano nan kaipo-ipogaw et enda kano makisikop isnan tinobaan nan sin-agi. Mas-at et kano abe da Batakagan ken Kido. Pomaytok da kano et enda maki-omong. Yaket anggay adi et kano omod-odan. Kinwanin kanon si Patti ay makin baey isnan longob di ginawang, "Apay sa ken anggay adi omod-odan ay. Nay matdok et nan danom et mabonsiyan nan edeg ko isnan longob di ginawang aynay. Ta kad ta umeyak ken Kido." Songsongen na kano nan danom isnan ginawang yan kanana. "Ay pay nan ginawang ay anggay manlang-es nan danom sinan nigay." Yaket datngena et si Batakagan ay anggay bebetakena

older brother said. So, they went back to the creek and gathered the fishes, wrapped it with the *Bila-bila* leaves, then burned it among the dried leaves. When the fishes were cooked, they ate their lunch. Afterwards, the older brother said, "Maybe there is something good on that tree. Let us get the fruits and leaves of that tree and use in gathering fishes." So, they went back to the creek, got all the fruits and leaves of the tree and brought it to the wide river. Then it is true, there were more dead fishes floating on the water. The two brothers gathered as much as they could. The community people came also to join the two brothers in gathering fishes. Even Batakagan (Star) and Kido (Thunder) came down from the sky and joined the throng in the river. Then the rain never came. Patti who is living in the depths of the river began to notice it and said to himself, "The river is almost dry and soon my back will be exposed under the sun. I guess I must visit Kido." So, Patti set out on his way but he smelled that the river stinks with dead fishes. "The river smells bad with dead fishes," he said to himself. Then he went on his way and he found Batakagan standing in the middle of the river. "Why are you standing there? Why don't you gather more fishes and then go home? Your companions have gone home already and yet there you are standing

san ginawang. "Ay pay sa ay adi kat ta tapiyan nan nigay mo ta soma-a kas nan baey mo ay." Nay anggay sinma-a nan kaib-a ib-am ay nakisikop isnan tinobaan di sin-agi dapay nay inana-ag mo mo," kinwanin Patti ken Batakagan. "Inmali kami iman maki-umong sinan tinobaan di sin-agi yan anggay maikpay mam nan awak ko yan anggay kokosiyapen abe nan matak dan nay yomekyekak si ke-es ko, yaket anggay adiyak komiwi," kinwanin si Batakagan. "Ay adi iman no adiyoy leglegan san awak yo dapay dakayo et baey yo ed tongdo et matikgi kayos ipogaw," kanan si Patti. "Adi adipay tay adiyak tinongo," kanan si Batakagan. "Saen adi pay et baey ko nan longob di ginawang et magay adiyak padatngen. Padateng ko nan ma-anod ay ipogaw weno oweg et nanga-ak si legle-legleg et kasiyan na ay wiswisinganak ay ipogaw," kanan kanon si Patti. Alana et san danom et leglegana si Batakagan. "Anggay, ta omeyak abe ken Kido ay," kinwanin Patti kano. Umey kanu ken Kido yan anggay kano ay isasalongayngay na. Inpopodan na kano sin segpan di baey yan nay anggay ay tinmapog nan tekak na isnan panengsadana. "Ay pay sa ken isasalongayngay mo ay nay tinmapog nan tekak mo isnan panengsaden di

still," Patti asked Batakagan. "We have come down from the sky to join gathering these fishes. Then I felt weak, my eyes can't see well, I got this persistent cough, and I can't even move," Batakagan answered. "Well, that will happen to you if you don't know how to wash yourself. You should have known that since you live in the sky," Patti told. "I don't know such things," Batakagan wailed. "Well, I lived in the depths of the river and always come across dirty waste that were washed away from people, animals or snakes but I always wash myself and I remain clean and strong," Patti said. Then he got water and washed Batakagan. "That's it. I must look for Kido right now," said Patti. When he reached the house of Kido, Patti saw him lying uncomfortably on the floor near his doorstep. "Why are you lying there uncomfortably? Your spit is everywhere in your doorsteps," asked Patti. "We have gone down to the river to join the people in gathering those fishes. When I came home, I got persistent cough, my eyes can't see well, and I can't even move myself," answered Kido. "That is so if you don't know how to wash yourself. You should have known that since you live there in the sky," told Patti. "I don't know such things," answered Kido. Then Patti got water and washed Kido. "That's it. I have to go home now," said Patti. When

baey mo mo,” kanan Patti. “Ay towan man na ay enkami nakisikop sinan tinobaan di sin-agi yaket anggay man ay yomekyekak si ke-es ko dapay itodo na saen yan makosiyapan nan ilan di matak, dan anggay ay adiyak komiwi,” kinwanin Kido ken Patti. “Ay adi iman no adi yo leglegan nan awak yo dapay dakayo et baey yo isna tongdo et matikgi kayos ipogaw,” kanan Patti ken Kido. “Adi pay tay adiyak tinongo,” kinwanin si Kido. Alaen kanon Patti san danom yan legleganas Kido. “Anggay siya ta soma-a ak ed baey ko,” kanan Patti. Mabengda pay kano si Patti isnan danan yan igsanen Kido ay mankido. “Ay mankido ka adi ete-ewa ta omodan ka ya maowasan san sinumngaw ay tinobaan di sin-agi,” kanan Patti. Domna pay kanos Patti sinan baey na yan pidwaan Kido ay mankido yan anggay mandeges et iyudan na. Nay pay ay manlegleg kami abe iman isnan danom ay mankesang aynay. No omodan at mabodekan ka, ya no maegew et mailing-enan ka et kasiyan na ay mankesang ka I ipugaw. Mapulpulag kas deppas yan kasiyan na ay ipogaw ka. Nay manlegleg kami na. Dawaten mi ken sik-a ay mantingnin ay danom aynay ta owasam et san kadodogis ya mawiswisingan kami abes ay ipogaw.

Patti was half way home, Kido began to thunder in the sky. “That’s right. You have to begin thundering so that it will rain and then you will wash away the bad smell of those fishes poisoned by the two brothers,” Patti said to himself as he looked upon the sky. When he reached home, Kido thundered the second time and the rain began to pour down. Here we are chanting this *Legleg* prayer with this clean water. When it rains, you will be mixed with the soil. When the rain stops you will become clean just as before. You are falling from a steep hill yet you are still the same. You are being crushed by big stones and yet you are still the same. When the river storms with big stones, you are still the same. Here we are asking you to wash and clean the community from anything unclean so that we will be blessed.

Sapon di Mangili-en

Wada kano nan I-Sumade. Enda kanon manganop et man-oo kano nan aso da isnan gawan di makaiw. Inmey da inila et dinatngan da nan nadalos ay kaiw ay maid bulong na yan tangaden da pay et maid kakkaban na. Ilaen da yan mayat si sabatan ay masapos baey kano. Sumaa da et enda ala-en laminta da, banig ya wasay da. Sada et omey sabatan nan kaiw adey. Ilaen da pay yan osto ay omanay at maisapos esay baey. Igawid da et ed Sumadel. Sapo-en das baey et malpas pay yan men-giwgiwed nan sinapo da. Sada et warwaren yan ibala da ed Masla. Wada pay ed Masla et sapoen das baey ya mankiwkiwi ladta. War-waren da abe et ibala da ed Lob-ong et sapoen das baey kasin ngem siya ladta ay mankiwkiwi. Warwaren da kasin et ibala da pay ed Tadian ya siya metlang kasin. Asi da et ibala ed Kabunagan pay yan kanan san amam-a ken daida ay, "Iyali yo nan swerten di man-ili. Alaen yo pay san mad-madi ta ikaan yo. Ilaen yo pay nan mangipapa-ila si kedse na ken dakami ta man-ipit yo isnan kaiw ay idad-dad-an yo ana ta adi da lowa-lowamen ay manglalais. Nay ay mangid-idew kami et maadawagan kayo ay mangili ay

Mangili-en Prayer

There were once hunters from Sumadel who went hunting. Their dog began barking in the middle of the forest. So, they look for their dog and found out that it was barking on a tree. They check the trunk of the tree and found out that it has no leaves, has no branches and there is no way anyone can climb it. They also saw that it is good for building a house. The hunters went home, got their bolos and axes and went back to the forest to cut the tree. Then, they made boards out of it and found out that it is enough to make a house. So, the hunters brought it home to build a house. When they finished building the house, they noticed that it is moving so they unbuilt it and brought the woods to Masla. They constructed the house there but same thing happened, the built house was moving. They unbuilt it again and brought it to Lubon and poblacion but the same thing happened. When the hunters reached Cabunagan, the community elders told them, "Bring to us those which is good luck in our community and get the bad things with you. Take not of those who mean to us and crush them with those woods you are carrying so that they will be warned." Here, we are doing this *id-idew* ritual, we entreat you to look after our children who are going to other places.

*mangila si an-akmi ay umey si teken ay
ili ta dakayo di mangisako si madmadi.
No wada di mangmangwani ay
mangedse ken dayda isdi ya dakayo
san mangtobab tan dakayo et man
dad-an kayo si kaagawan ya labi”.*

Guard them and ward off those who are
planning to hurt them because who are
watching us day and night.

Sapon di Nandosdos

*Wada san inmey nanganop. Ilan da
pay nan longib di kaiw yan kanan da
“Sino pay nan gig-iyakan di aso, enta
kad ilan,” kanan kanon mansin-agi.
Ilanda pay yan lungob di kaiw. “Nay
maid et sinenggapan di maanupan,”
kanan da kano. Sida’t nemnemen, isa-
a ta sapoen ta et si solibao. Sida pay
isa-a kano et dosdosan da, imanman
da, sapoen da si solibao. Sida pay
salibawen kano pay ya man gayeng
nan kalin di Solibao da. Anggay et ay
no mamegnas da ya siya nan inbala
da. Yaken et agomen nan kaipo-
ipogaw, masapo et nan lagsak di ili.
Anggay et ay no mamegnas da ya siya
di sinolibao da.*

Nandosdos Prayer

There were hunters who went hunting.
Their dog was barking somewhere out in
the woods so the hunters set out to check
their dog. They found out that the dog was
barking on a log. The hunters checked the
log and found out that it has a hole inside.
Then, they thought of bringing it home and
planned to make it as a *solibao* out of it.
When they reached home, they
smoothened the outer part of the log and
shaped it into a *solibao*. When they
finished making the *solibao* and beat it with
their hands, it produces a good sound.
From that time on, whenever the *begnas*
was held, they will bring out the *solibao*
and the people from the community
gathers for a feast.

When the seven different prayers were already chanted, the one who holds the *begnas* will chant this prayer:

Ay iswerten di men-ili

Goodluck to the Community People!

Then the elders who participated in the ritual will eat and afterwards stay at the *At-ato-an* to wait for the dawn. This ritual must be observed so that if the ritualist found

a *simlit* bile sac from the sacrificial animal, the looking of a *labeg* at dawn will be conducted.

The elders said that if in case there is a wake near the premises of the *at-ato-an* where the *id-idew* is to be held, the *id-idew* ritual shall be performed in another *at-ato-an*.

Another part of the *Begnas* is the looking for a *Labeg* which will take place at dawn around Five o'clock in the morning. The elders who performed the *id-idew* ritual will go to Bago (a place) to look for an omen. In case they found a bad omen like snake, rat and crow (*gayang*), the men will go home part ways and they will do the same thing the next day until they found a good omen. It was believed that a snake is a bad omen since it bites people. It also symbolizes dis-unity. The rat is also a bad omen because it eats the rice crop. The crow or *gayang* is a bad luck because of its color. Its black color symbolizes ashes which imply burning down of houses. However, if the elders found a *tala* (mocking bird) or a *labey*, it means a good omen.

According to unwritten source, a *tala* is a good omen because it was once an old woman who went to the fields to watch the rice crop. Because she was not given food to eat by her family, she wished to become a *tala* so that she could eat worms while watching the rice crops at the same time. Her wish came true and she became a *tala*. *Labey* or *tala* is a good omen because according to oral traditions, the *labey* was once an old woman who cannot help her family in the fields because she was physically disabled. She prayed to become a bird so that she can go wherever she likes. Her prayer was granted and she became a bird called *labey*.

As soon as the elders found a good omen, they will go back to the community to start the *begnas*. As they reached the community, the one who holds the *begnas* will chant the prayer.

Ny isagang da nan swerte, ta swerte nan umali isnan ili ya menswerte abe nan umili.

The performers will proceed to the *at-atoan* of Gawa and perform the *Kananaw* wherein they will open a jar of *tapey* and do the *pitik* prayer. The elder who was assigned to hold the *begnas* will chant this prayer:



Fig. 3 Balag-ay, Joneth C., personal photograph, “The elder seated second from the left, doing the *Pitik*,” March 2017.

SAPON DI PITIK

Naey di tapey aynay ay ipitik mi. Dakayo ay inumbon isnan at-atoan ed Bangsaan, ed Gawa, ed Polpoligan, ed Lumnek, ya ed Cabunagan naey di tapey, umali kayo ta ipitik tako na. Daligan yo nan kaonga-onga ta egkan da I makilagbo ya egkan da I men-adal tan edwani siya nan adalen di ipugaw nan eskwelaan. Makilagbo nan daum, umey das siyudad tay siya nan makilagboan di ipugaw. Daligan yo et nan kaana-anak ta mailislisi da si kadodogis. No waday domateng si panateng, mailis lisi ken daida, swerte et nan manpaay ta makilagbo da. Tasay no waday ilagboan da ya manokmon da, waday kaisamidan yo.

Pitik Prayer

Here is the rice wine. We invite the spirits living in the *at-ato-an* of Bangsaan, spirits in the *at-ato-an* of Gawa, spirits in the *at-ato-an* of Polpoligan, spirits in the *at-ato-an* of Lumnek, and spirits in the *at-atoan* of Cabunagan to join in our *Begnas* celebration. Protect our children from bad luck so that they will prosper and finish their education because nowadays people should finish a degree in order to get a job. Others will go to the city to find for a job so protect them also, from sickness like colds so that blessings will always be with them. If it they will receive their salaries they will share it with us.

When the *pitik* prayer is done, they will begin chanting the *day-eng*. Afterwards, they will do the *dinggayos* wherein the elder assigned will chant the following prayer:



Fig. 4 Balag-ay, Joneth C., personal photograph, "Elders Chanting the Kananaw Prayers," March 2017.

*Gange, gange, gange; nemnem mo / "Gange, gange, gange; It is your choice
inmali, toktok mo ay magopi-gopi. to come here. May your head be
deformed.*

When the chant is finished, the men will play their gongs, dance and drink *tapey*.
The community folks will join in the celebration also.



Fig.5 Balag-ay, Joneth C., personal photograph, "First Day of Begnas after the Giyaw: Rubwat di Gangsa, Nangibalaan da sin Batawa di At-atoan," March 2017.



Fig. 6 Balag-ay, Joneth C., personal photograph, "First Day of Community Playing and Dancing with the Gongs," March 2017.



Fig. 7 Balag-ay, Joneth C., personal photograph, "First Night after the Giyaw," March 2017.

2. PATAY. This ritual is to be performed by the elders who did the *id-idew ritual*. This is the second ritual to be performed at around Nine O'clock in the morning and end at Twelve O'clock noon or depending on the progress of the performance of the ritual during the second day of the *begnas* celebration. This ritual must be observed so that the elders will know what kind of chicken is to be butchered during the *giwaday* ritual. This is done by observing the bile sac of the animal being offered during the ritual. In this ritual, the elders will require a *bulla* because it is believed that it will chase away bad luck from the community. The *bulla* can either two or three months old, color black or mixed, circumcised and has never mate with other pigs. It has to be physically

perfect because the spirits do not want a defective offering or with blemishes. It will be butchered with the use of an *iwik*. The performers will cook rice during the ritual so that when the *patay* ritual is done, they will eat their meal immediately. All the cooking will be done over the firewood which were prepared beforehand. The elders will perform their ritual at a sacred place whom the call *Patpatayan* When the *bull* is already dead, the elder who is appointed to hold the *Begnas* will chant the *sipgid* prayer:

Sapon di Sipgid

Dakayo ay inmun-una ed nabaon, no menpatay kayo et enyo insipgid yan siyay insuwerte yo isnan insama yo, ya in-ganak yo si babae ya lalaki, ya say inyamis yo si makedse, ya say in-adal di an-ak ya ap-o yo. Nay mansipgip kami abe tasay umat ken dakami.

Sipgid Prayer

Our ancestors, when you perform the ritual, you chant the *sipgid* prayer. This is the reason why you have good harvest, good child rearing, in getting even to those who are mean to you, and in the education of your children. We are chanting this sipgid prayer so that the good fortune will also be given to us also

When the leader finished chanting the *sipgid* prayer, he will get the wooden peg which was used to kill the pig and chants the *Iwik* prayer:



Fig. 8 Balag-ay, Joneth C., personal photograph, “Mr Daguio Doing the Iwik while the Other Men Tightly Hold the Pig,” March 2017.

Sapon di Iwik

Dakayo ay inmun-una ed nabaon, no

Iwik Prayer

Our ancestors, when you finished

malpas yo ay insipgid nan otik et ibuyag yo abe nan iwik et say inswerte yo isnan insama yo, ya in-ganak yo si babae ya lalaki, ya say inyamis yo si makedse, ya say in-adal di an-ak yo ap-o yo. Nay ibuyag mi abe san iwik ay nay et say umat abe ken dakami.

chanting your sipgid prayer, you get the peg which you used in butchering your offering and bless it. This has given you good fortune in your harvest, in rearing children, in getting even with those mean to you, and in your children's education. We are following your example so that it will also happen to us.

When the ritual leader finished praying for the peg (iwik), they will butcher the sacrificial animal and inspect its bile sac after which they will cook it.



Fig. 9 Balag-ay, Joneth C., personal photograph, "Singeing of the Hair of Pig before Butchering it," March 2017.

When it is done, they will prepare three plates of cooked rice with the meat. The elders will again distribute the seven ritual prayers among themselves. These are the prayers chanted during the *id-idew* ritual. The ones appointed to hold the *begnas* will chant the *Loto* prayer. They will chant the prayers simultaneously. Afterwards, they will eat, then they will go to Gawa and join in the playing and dancing with the gongs. While on their way, they will shout *Aye, aye, aye*. This *patay* ritual is necessary so that the elders will know which material is to be butchered during the *giwaday* ritual.



Fig. 10 Balag-ay, Joneth C., personal photograph, "At Patpatayan after the Performance of the Patay Ritual," March 2017.

3. GIWADAY. This is to be performed the night of the second day of the *Begnas*. The performers will gather at the *At-ato-an of Gawa* and begin the ritual at around eight o'clock in the evening. They will butcher a chicken depending on the bile sac of the animal butchered during the patay ritual which is either a *mamasang* or an *obo-an*. They believed that the good fortune will be inherited by their future children at the same time stays in the community. If the bile sac of the animal butchered during the patay was *kopis* they will butcher an *obo-an*. But if the bile sac was *naekban* or *simlit*, the chicken to be offered should be a *mamasang*. The chicken will be butchered and cooked through *pinikpikan style*. The one who was appointed to hold the *Begnas* will chant the following prayer:

Sapon di Giwaday

*Dakayo ay inmun-una ed nabaon, no
man giwaday kayo et enyo ikararag yan
say sinumyaan yo isnan insama yo, ya
in-ganak yo si babae ya lalaki; ya say
inyamis yo si makedse; ya say in-adal di
an-ak ya ap-o yo. Nay man-giwaday
kami tasay umat abe ken dakami.*

Giwaday Prayer

Our ancestors, when you perform the giwaday ritual, you bless it through a prayer. This was the reason you got abundant harvest, blessed with children, got even with those bad to you, and your children to finish their education. We are doing this ritual so that it will happen to us also.

When the leader finished chanting the prayer, they will butcher and cook the

chicken. If the meat is already cooked, the performers will distribute among themselves the seven ritual prayers. The Loto prayer will be chanted by the leader, the one who was appointed to hold the *begnas*.

After chanting the seven ritual prayers, the leader will chant the *Liwat* prayer:

Sapon di Liwat

Liwat Prayer

I-swerten di men-ili, iyanak das babae ya May this be the community's good
lalaki, i-swerten di an-ak ya ap-o da si fortune in bearing children and in their
adal ta no maka-adal da ya no men-anap children's education so that when they
da si ubla ya nalalaka san maawatan da seek jobs, they will easily get employed.
si ubla.

After chanting the *liwat* prayer, the performers will eat their meal and may go home afterwards.

The one who was appointed to hold the *Begnas* is obliged to stay in the community and not to travel so that *sika* will stay in the community. It is believed that when the one who holds the *Begnas* will travel, the *sika* also gets away from the community.

4. TENGAO. This ritual takes place a day after the *Giwaday* ritual at the *At-atoan of Gawa*. According to Mr. Kobeng, the elders will assemble at around 8 o'clock in the morning to begin the ritual. They will butcher the *Lokbo*, then the elders will inspect its bile sac. If the bile sac is not *simlit*, they will require another *lokbo* until they find a *simlit* bile sac. As soon as the meat is already half-cooked, they will get two plates of cooked rice with pieces of meat and a *toway* of *tapey* and give it to the ritual leader. The leader of the ritual will chant the *tengao* prayer.

It is the fourth ritual to be performed during the *Begnas* celebration. Someone is assigned to go to the ricefield to do the *wakey* in his own seedbed then goes home. The elder on the other hand will perform this *tengao* ritual. A *lokbo* is required during the ritual because it is believed that it gives good fortune to the children's future. The pig has to be physically healthy and perfect. Its color should be colored black or mixed with colors. The elders are however not strict as to whether the pig is native or half-breed because nowadays, people prefer to take care of half-breed pigs. They will also cook rice during the ritual and then eat their meals afterwards.

Sapon di Tengao

Wada kano si Lumawig ay naganak. Maad-ado pay kano nan ganak nay an ena alaen nan otik da et menpakde da. "Ta man tengao kayo ta say no wada di isama yo ya umanay si katagowan yo," kanan kano si Lumawig. Et siyay inyat da kano yan dayda et di sinumya ay ipogaw. Asida da pay ibala isnan ili et ipaytok da ed Tabeyo et siyay inyat da. Ipaytok da abe isna Balaoa et sublaten da. Siya di enda natago-tagowan.

Tengao Prayer

When Lumawig got married and had many children, he got his pig and performed the ritual. "Let's do this so that when you plant, it will be enough for your consumption", he said. When they perform the ritual, they were blessed. Then, they taught this ritual to the Tabeyo community and they followed. They taught this ritual to Balaoa community and follow their example also.

After the leader was done praying, they will cook the meat again and eat. The leftover meat will be cut into small pieces called *wadag* and be distributed to the entire community households. The following is the *wadag* prayer to be chanted by the person appointed to distribute the meat in every household.



Fig. 11 Balag-ay, Joneth C., personal photograph, "Wadag," March 2017

Sapon di Wadag

Kombasa ay mabakwa, paksay ay kadaksadaksay, lilin ay maol-olin, pagey ay anando mapno nan da-o.

Wadag Prayer

Big heavy squash, abundant legumes, rolling gabi, palay heavy with grains will fill the rice granaries.

5. KENTA. This is the fifth and the last ritual to be observed during the *Begnas* celebration. Mr. Mariano Mangamti discussed that this ritual is to be performed to close the ritual activities of the *Begnas*. It is to be performed a day after the *Tengao* at the *At-ato-an of Gawa*. The elders require a *mamasang*. They are not strict as to what color or weight the chicken has, but it has to be physically perfect because they believed that the spirits don't favor a defective offering. Its bile sac is to be inspected. If the bile sac is *simlit*, the ritual continues. This brings good fortune for the children. They will cook rice during this ritual and eat their meals afterwards. The cooking will be done over a set of firewood prepared by the elders beforehand.

Sapon di Kenta

Kenta Prayer

<i>Na ay menkenta san ili tay nay inkamin</i> <i>namegnas. Dakayo ay inmun-una ed</i> <i>nabaon et siya nan inyaat yo. Nay iman</i> <i>ay bumegnas kami et nay kentaen mi et</i> <i>sina ay di swerten di man ili si maisama,</i> <i>si adal, si ubla ya si latang.</i>	Our ancestors, we are performing this Kenta ritual because you did this before. As we celebrate this Begnas, may this be our good fortune in good harvest, in education and in buying of land properties.
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The meat will be cooked after the leader chants the prayer.

This Begnas celebration should be observed precisely as it should be not to displease the ancestors and the gods. This is the reason why the elders are very much strict in prescribing which animals to be offered, in inspecting the bile sac and in the observance of the taboos. This is a way of giving thanks and entreating the ancestors and the gods for a good and abundant harvest. This fact is very much manifested on the ritual prayers which the elders chants during each ritual ceremony.

Values: Since abundance and good fortune is very much emphasized in the celebration of the Begnas at the beginning of the rice farming activity, this has played a lot in boosting the spiritual mentality of the community people of Balaoa. It helped them to do their work happily under the influence of positive thinking. It also helps them do their work diligently and prevents them from cheating other people because they put in mind that their ancestors and the gods are helping them. Each farmer will treat each other wisely and respectfully for fear of displeasing the gods.

II. Transplanting Period

The following rituals are ways of entreating the spirits, ancestors and the gods to guard, protect and make their crops grow robust and bear abundant fruits. This fact is very much manifested on the ritual prayers and the purpose of each ritual. The elders are very strict on the animals to be offered and in inspecting the bile sac because they fear to displease the unseen forces and to ensure good fortune. This is the reason why the elders set high standards. They require a perfect offering which each bile sac has its meaning and must be dealt with utmost strictness. The performance of these rituals helps the community people rest from the just finished activity. Since the community people rest during the performance of the rituals, they would regain their energy which they exerted during the transplanting activity.

A. KENTA. Mr. Homer Daguio related that this is a closing ritual to all the activities in the transplanting period. This kenta ritual initiated by an elder is to be performed when the people have finished the transplanting activities. This is being performed gradually by all the elders in each *at-ato-an* of Barangay Balaoa. The elders of Purok Polpoligan will perform this ritual at their *at-ato-an*, the following day, the elders of Purok lumnek will also perform this ritual at their *at-ato-an*. The following day, the elders of Bangsaan will also perform the same ritual at their *at-ato-an* and can also be followed by the elders of Gawa who will also perform the same ritual the next day. Then the other elders of the various *at-ato-an* will perform their rituals in the succeeding days.

In the performance of the kenta ritual, the following materials should be prepared: gongs, solibao, tapey, water, liquor (San Miguel), rice, big pots, firewood and a *mamasang*. The color of the chicken to be offered is not necessarily observed. However, it should be physically healthy and perfect. The *mamasang* is perfect and is believed to bring good fortune for the children who are finishing their college courses, seeking a job, and making their life better. The cooking is done over a set of fire wood prepared by the elders before the ritual begun.

The performers will gather at their respective *at-ato-an* to butcher a *mamasang*. They will inspect the bile sac of the chicken. If the bile sac is *kopis*, they will require another chicken which is *pinmingsan* because it is believed that it will give water to the *kopis* which is waterless. Since a *pinmingsan* is still young and has experience taking care of chicks, the elders believe that a *pinmingsan* will also gather the community children to good fortune such as employment, abundance in harvest, and the like. If

they found a simlit bile sac, the elder assigned will proceed in the chanting of the Kenta prayer:

Sapon di Kenta

*Nay ay menkenta nan men-ili. Dakayo ay
pinteng di Hapon, pinteng di gerilya,
pinteng di danum, tinmengao ed
Ngilngilinan, tinmengao kad Kadkad, sik-
a ay Agew ay kinmusilap ed tongdo,
agewam nan iyat di umili ay mensama,
sik-a ay Buwan nay buwanam nan
insama da, ya dakayo ay inombon ed
Gawa aynay ilan yo abe ta liwidan yo nan
ili ay nay.*

Kenta Prayer

We, the community people will perform this Kenta ritual. Spirits from war, spirit from accidents, spirits who live in Ngilngilinan, in Kadkad, to the Sun, to the Moon, and spirits who live in Gawa, protect the plants, the community people so it will grow robusts and bear much.

When the elders finished chanting the prayer, they will cook the meat and then eat their meals afterwards.

B. LEPLEPAS DI TUNED. This ritual can be performed by anybody in the family who knows how to perform the ritual in their own house. It is initiated to celebrate the commencement of the rice planting activity. In the performance, the following are the materials to be prepared: rice wine, rice, small pots, firewood and a *mamasang*. The color of the chicken to be offered is not necessarily observed but, it must be physically perfect. The chicken will be killed by slowly beating its wings, its neck and its head with a piece of stick until it gradually dies (pinikpikan style). The leader of the ritual will chant this prayer:

Sapon di lelepas di Tuned

*Nay ipiyakan mi san lelepas di tuned mi
aynay ta siya et di
i-tingtingnin di pamilya mi, i-swerte mi si
sama, ya i-swerte mi si talaken mi.*

Leplepas di Tuned Prayer

We will butcher chicken for this finished planting period ritual so that it will become good fortune to our family, in our plants, and so with our animals.

When the chanting of the prayer is done, they will butcher and cook the chicken.

When it is already cooked, they will put it in a serving plate and give it to the ritual leader who will chant the *Loto* prayer:

Sapon di Loto

*Nay ilotok iman san lelepas di tuned
aynay ta siya et di i-ting-tingnin di
pamilya mi, i-swerte mi si sama, ya i-
swerte mi si talaken.*

Loto Prayer

I am chanting this *Loto* prayer for this ritual for the peace and goodluck of our family, our plants and animals.

After the prayer is chanted, the family will eat their meals together. While waiting for their rice plants to bear grains, the people will also go to their *uma*. They will prepare their *uma* where they will plant camote, corn, peanuts and other vegetables.

III. PRE-HARVEST PERIOD

A. DENET. This is a ritual being performed during the pre-harvest period. when the rice grains turn into yellowish color. This is performed in a rice field by anybody in the household who knows how to do it and wants to observe the ritual. This ritual is being observed because they believed that their crops will bear abundant harvest. The materials to be used are small pots, firewood, rice, ricewine. Three or five pieces of sticks with its leaves, a *mamasang* for the common people and a *lokbo* for the rich people. Three or five pieces of sticks are required because the elders prefer odd numbers than even numbers and these is what they have been using in the olden days. They say that even numbers are complete. Thus, they have to use an incomplete or odd number in performing this ritual following their predecessor's examples.

If the performer of the ritual is a common individual, a *mamasang* is required. The observance of the color of the chicken to be offeed is not necessary but it should be physically perfect and healthy. The performer will go to his own rice field and then chant the *Tapey* prayer.

Sapon di Tapey

*Nay di tapey aynay. Dakayo ay naliwes
si nan salolongan aynay, inumen yo san
tapey aynay. Itayaw yo san madmadi tan*

Prayer for the Tapey

I am offering this *tapey* to all spirits who are living around this rice fields. Drink this rice wine. Remove the bad luck by

dakayo et mantayaw kayo ta swerte et san manpaay isnan anan-ak umal-alisna ya manam-sama isna.

bringing it with you because you can fly everywhere. May this be a good fortune for our children who are tending this rice field.

After chanting the prayer, they will kill the chicken, then the performer stands and chants the *Buyag Prayer*:

Sapon di Buyag

Nay ibuyag ko nan manok aynay. Dakayo ay napo-an ay namos, dakayo nan nan den-denet isna sin kamatago yo et say sinumyaan yo, di talaken yo, ya inganak yo. Nay naganak kayo et na ay kami ay ap-o yo. Nay ay denetan mi pay san okay o ay indawat yo ken dakami et sinay et di i-swerten di an-ak mi tasay no denetan mi na ya adi kalinglingan nagan yo ay nakin oka ay napo-an mi.

Buyag Prayer

Our old ancestors, you were the one who are performing this denet ritual in your lifetime and it became your good fortune in your plants, animals and bearing children. We follow your example and perform the ritual in this rice field so that good fortune will come to us also, and your name will not be forgotten.

When the performer is finished praying, they will butcher the chicken and cook it. Then the performer chants the following prayer:

Sapon di Denet

Naay denetak nan payew aynay. Sik-a ay Lumawig, sik-a nan na-on ona ay nangitdo isnan nangkap-owan ay namos et siya nan inswerte da ya sinmika-an nan insamada. Nay pay abe edwani et denetan mi abe nan payew mi aynay ta say siya abe san sumika-an nan insama mi ya inswerten di pamilya mi.

Denet Prayer

Lumawig, you were the one taught this ritual to our ancestors and it became their good fortune and has abundance in their harvest. We also perform this ritual so that we will also have abundance in harvest and good fortune will come to our family.

After praying, they eat their meals. When they finished eating, the performer

again chants this prayer: “*Nay masika nan makan*” (Abundant food). The performer erects the *padang* which is composed of three or five pieces of sticks with leaves and let it stand on the rice paddies. Then he will chant the following prayer:

Sapon di Padang

*Ala-em san pa-o aynay ta magabay san
insama mi ta isus-swerte mi na.*

Padang Prayer

Get these pieces of sticks to make our plants grow, bear much fruits and be our good fortune.

Afterwards, the one who performed the ritual gathers his belongings and prepares to go home. He must never talk to anybody along his way home and must never sleep because it is believed that the rice crops will also be sleepy.

For the rich people, if they want to perform this ritual, they will follow the stated procedures above. The only difference is, they will butcher a *lokbo* as their sacrificial animal. It should be black or *labang* in color, two or three months old, and physically perfect.

The performance of the *denet* ritual before the harvest period is a way of entreating the ancestors to make their rice crops bear much fruits and brings good fortune. This fact is very much manifested on the prayers chanted during the ritual. In order to ensure good fortune and abundant harvest, the elders have to be strict on the animal to be offered and in inspecting its bile sac. The one who does the ritual must also observe some taboos in order not to displease the unseen forces. It is believed that the smoke coming from the firewood used in cooking the sacrificial animal during the *denet* ritual in the rice fields helps the rice crops bear much grain.

This is the time wherein people will remove the weeds from their ricefields especially the *saksakong*. They call this as *panagkakagamo*. To nurture their plant, they are making use of animal manure, rice husk and rotten plants, etc as fertilizer.

When the grains start to turn yellow, they will do the *bewew* wherein people will put scarecrows to their ricefields which will help drove away birds specially *biding* that ate their palay. They will also put *saltok* which will help trap rats that also eat their rice plants. Those who does the *bewew* must not shout or say something bad about the birds because they believed that the birds will call their fellow birds to eat the grains especially when no one is looking after their plants.

IV. Harvesting Period

a. **BEGNAS.** This is observed before the harvesting period takes place. This is to celebrate the upcoming harvest activity and to thank *Kabunian*. The performers are the elders of the community. The rituals to be performed are the same with the rituals performed during the first celebration before the land and seedbed preparation. Some of the rituals however will not be performed such as: the *Giwaday*, the *Tengao* and the *Kenta* because the palays are ready to be harvested.

The old folks have to see to it that the activity be observed during the new moon or *beska* for it entails good harvest.

V. Post-Harvest Period.

A. **KENTA.** This is a closing ritual that ends all the ritual activities. tHIS is performed when community people are finished in their harvest activity. The community elders will announce a *tengao* and the elders will perform the *Kenta* ritual at the *At-ato-an*. They will prepare the following materials: gongs, solibao, drinks such as tapey san Miguel and water, rice big pots, firewood and a *lokbo*. The *lokbo* is preferred because the elders believed that the good fortune will go to the young children. It should be black or labang in color, two-three months old and is physically healthy and perfect because the elders believed that if they will offer a *lokbo* which is not physically perfect their children will also get married to a person who is physically defective.

During the ritual, the *lokbo* is butchered and its bile sac is inspected by the elders. If the bile sac is *lapsot*, they will require a female pig that is *pinmingsan* because it is believed that this pig is a good fortune in making their harvest abundant enough for family consumption until the next farming season. The leader will chant the following prayer:

Sapon di Kenta

Nay menkenta san men-ili tan nalpas nan ani mi. dakayo ay inmu-una ed nabaon et siyay inyaat yon a yan siya di sinumyaan yo. Nay abe ay kentaen mi edwani ta siya et abe si iswerten di men-ili si maisama, adal, ubla ya latang.

Kenta Prayer

Our ancestors, you were the first to perform this kenta ritual when you were done with the harvest activity and got an abundant harvest. We are also following your example so that the good luck will come to our harvest.

When the leader has finished chanting the prayer, they will cook the meat and eat their meal.

During the *tengao*, nobody is allowed to go to the fields.

B. LEPLEPAS DI ANI. This ritual is performed by someone from the household to celebrate the stored palay in their rice granary so that the *sika* will always be in their house. It is believed that if this is performed, the stored palay will be enough for the consumption of the family until the next harvest season. In this ritual, the following materials are required: rice wine, rice, and a *mamasang*. The color of the chicken or the *mamasang* to be offered is not necessarily observed. However, it should be physically perfect because they believed that the chicken brings good fortune to the family household's rice crop and to the children when seeking a job to improve their life status.

During the ritual, the *mamasang* will be butchered. The eldest man in the house who usually do the ritual holds the live chicken and bless it with this prayer:

Sapon di Buyag

Buyag Prayer

<i>Dakayo ay nangkap-owan mi ay namos</i>	Our ancestors, you were the ones who
<i>aynay da, dakayo san inmun-una ay</i>	were performing this ritual in your
<i>nangnangyat sina. No maapit ta</i>	lifetime. When you harvested your palay,
<i>matapog san insama yo isnan agamang</i>	you fill your rice granary to the fullest.
<i>yo yan enkayo ipiyakan yaket siya di</i>	You will butcher a sacrificial animal so
<i>sinmikaan di insama yo, siya di</i>	that you will have a good fortune and
<i>intingtingnin yo. Nay ay eyat mi na ta</i>	have abundant harvest. We also follow
<i>siyay umat abe sinan pamilya mi.</i>	your example so that it will happen to our
	family.

When the chicken was blessed, the eldest man will get a bowl of *tapey* and bless it with this prayer:

Sapon di Tapey

Dakayo ay nangkap-owan mi ay namos anay da, wada kayo amin sina tan dakayo san inmun-una ay nangnangyat isna sin kamatago yo. No maapit ya matapog san insama yo isnan agamang yo yan ala-en yo nan tapey yo et ikarkararag yo isnan nangkap-owan yo ay nat-natey yaket siya di intingtingnin yo ya in-ganak yo, in swerte yo si sama, ya talaken yo. Nay say iyat mi ta siyay umat abe sinan pamilya mi.

Tapey Prayer

Our ancestor, you were the first who were performing this ritual during your lifetime. When you harvested your palay, you fill your rice granaries to the fullest. Then you get your rice wine and pray it to your ancestors and it became your good fortune in bearing children, in good harvest, and in your animal increase. We follow your example so that it will happen to our family also.

When the performer finished his prayer, they will kill the chicken by beating its wings, neck and its head with the use of a stick until it dies. Then the performer will lift the dead chicken in the air and chant the *wasawas* prayer:

Sapon di Wasawas

Nay iwasawas mi nan inala mi ay makan aynay ta siya et iman di sumikaan di makan, ya ta siya di sumikasikaan din insaman di an-ak ay nagin baey sina.

Wasawas Prayer

Our ancestors we are waving this chicken so that it will become our good fortune for abundant food in this house and to our children.

After the Wasawas prayer, the elder puts down the chicken to be butchered and cooked. If the meat is already cooked, they will put it in a serving plate to be blessed again by the elder with the *Sapon di Loto*:

Sapon di Loto

Nay ilotok na. Dakayo ay nangkap-owan mi ay namos aynay da, dakayo san inmun-una ay nangnangyat sina. No maapit ya matopog san insama yo isnan agamang yo yan enkayo iloto yaket siya

Loto Prayer

Our ancestors, you were the first ones to perform this ritual during your lifetime. When you harvested your palay, you fill your rice granary to the fullest. Then you butcher a chicken so that it will become

di sinmikaan di insaman di an-ak yo. Yat your good fortune for abundant harvest.
mi abe ta siyay sumikaan da an-ak ay We will follow your example so that it will
nangin baey sina. happen to us also.

When the *Sapon di Loto* is over, the entire household family member will eat their meal. One of the family members will put a *padang* on their gate to inform the visitor and other community people that they are performing a ritual. A visitor is prohibited to enter the house because it is believed that when a visitor enters a house during ritual, it is a bad luck since *sika* will be taken away by the visitor.

The performance of the *Kenta* and the *leplepas di Ani* ritual is a way of celebrating the stored palay in their rice granary so that the *sika* will always be in their house and so that it will be enough for consumption until the next harvest season. This fact is also manifested on the ritual prayers and on the purpose of each ritual. This is the reason why the elders are very much strict when it comes to the performance of the rituals, the animals to be offered and the inspection of the bile sac for fear of displeasing the unseen forces and to ensure good fortune. The performance of the rituals helps the people rest from the finished activity because they will be able to regain the energy which they exerted during the activity. It also helps the people trust the unseen forces for help.

CONSEQUENCES OF NON-OBSERVANCE OF RITUALS

Land and Seedbed Preparation

Begnas

The community people believe that those who will not join in the celebration will be left alone by the *tinmengao*. The *tinmengao* will not protect their rice crops from calamity. According to the elders, when the community is holding their *begnas*, the *tinmengao* are also having their *begnas* at the same time. So, if the *tinmengao* found out that someone from the community is going to the field, the *tinmengao* will take note of him so that during calamity, they will not protect his rice fields and rice crops. They will even punish him by inflicting illness or sickness.

Transplanting Period

Kenta and Leplepas di Tuned

If the people will not observe these rituals, the *pinteng* and the *tinmengao* will

not make their rice crops bear much fruit and they will not have an abundant harvest.

Pre-harvest Period

Denet

Those who will not observe this ritual will not be blessed by the *tinmengao*. Their harvest will not be enough for their family until the next rice harvest.

Harvesting Period

Begnas

Those who will not participate in the *begnas* will experience frustration because the rice birds and the rats will attack their rice crops that are ready for harvest.

Post-harvest Period

Kenta and Leplepas di Ani

If these rituals will not be observed, the palay which was stored in the rice granary will not be enough for the family consumption until the next harvest.

To avoid the consequences, all the people of Balaoa should participate in the community affairs where the rituals are performed with prayers for the unseen forces to bless their health and economic endeavor.

REMEDIES OBSERVED FOR THE CONSEQUENCES ON NON-OBSERVANCE OF THE RITUALS

Land and Seedbed Preparation

Begnas

Toltolod di sakit ritual. There are those people who tend to go against the community laws. When they get sick, they will ask help from the elders. The elders will in turn associate this to violation of community laws. They believed that the *tinmengao* punish people by inflicting sickness. If most of the community people are getting sick, they will decide to perform the *toltolod di sakit* ritual wherein the elders will gather at the *at-ato-an* and have a short meeting. They will discuss among themselves on who will handle the ritual and what they will bring during the ritual. Then they will assign someone who will go from house to house in the whole *purok* where the sickness was inflicted to inform the people of the ritual to be conducted and ask a representative from each household to go to the *at-ato-an*. The household representative will then chant this prayer before leaving his house:

<i>Nay umali kayo ay mangili anynay ta</i>	Come visitors. Do not stay longer in
<i>adi yo iman itete-e isna. Nay ayagan</i>	this place. They are inviting you to
<i>da dakayo ed at- ato-an ta maagom</i>	come to the at-ato-an so that all of
<i>kayo ta maitolod kayo tay nay</i>	you will be sent away. Here are your
<i>mabaonan kayo. Nay insagana da</i>	packed food and your fare for your
<i>nan plete ya kanen yo.</i>	travel.

When every household representative gathered at the *at-ato-an*, they will assign the young men to carry the *baon* of the *mangili* (Sakit or sickness). The *baon* consists of bananas, cooked rice, cooked meat, and cooked eggs. The assigned elder will chant this prayer before they will go to the barangay boundary:

<i>Nay umey mi itolod dakayo ay mangili</i>	We will send you off from our place.
<i>tay nay mabaonan kayo et ta adi yo</i>	We are giving you your pack of food
<i>aped itete isna ili mi ayay.</i>	and fare for your journey.

When they reach the boundary, the assigned elder will chant this prayer:

nay mangan kayo tay nay di kanen Our visitors come eat. Here are your
yo. Nay abe di dulse-en yo. food and your desserts which we
prepared for you.

After the prayer, everybody will eat their meals. After eating, the elder will chant this prayer:

Nay nakakan kayo et nay di baon yo Now that you have finished eating,
ya nay din plete yo ta kumaan kayo we are giving you your packed foods
isnan ili mi aynay. and fare for your journey.

The left-over meals will be wrapped and hidden on the place where the ritual took place. Afterwards, everybody goes home and resume to their daily activities.

Transplanting Period

Kenta and lelepas di Tuned. When the people realized that their rice crops does not grow robust and do not bear much rice grains, they will observe these rituals during the next farming season.

Pre-harvest and Harvest period

Begnas and Denet. These two rituals have the same purpose and that is for the abundance of harvest. If the rats ate most of the rice crops because there are some who did not participate in the observance of the rituals, they will perform the *toltolod di utot ritual*.

Tultolod di Utot Ritual. The elders will hold a meeting at the at-ato-an and they will decide on who among themselves will hold the ritual. The purpose of this ritual is to send away the rats to the Ilocos Region. The elders will bring with them at the barangay boundary rice wine and salted meat. The one who holds the ritual will chant the following:

Nay mangan kayo et ta umey ed Loko Our visitors, come and eat and we will
ay sana tay adida tinungo ay itulod send you off to the Ilocos because

dakayo. Nay di tapey ya karne ta say they do not know how to send you
baon yon a. there. We have prepared meat and
rice wine as your food during your
travel.

After the prayer, they will hide the salted meat and the rice wine on the place where they did the ritual and then go home.

Post-harvest Period

Kenta and Lelepas di Ani. If those who did not observe the *Kenta and Lelepas di ani* ritual will consume their palay harvest in a short period of time, they will realize that this is because they did not observe these rituals. Thus, when they will gather all their palay harvest on the next harvest season, they will perform these rituals.

GLOSSARY

At-atoan is a place where the old folks perform their community rituals

Begnas is the merriest in the community during the olden days. It is being done as thanksgiving for abundant harvest.

Binmawi is a prayer for prestige in the community.

Bulla is a male pig.

Day-eng is a native song.

Delway means that the bile sac has protruded a little.

Dinggayos is a chant performed during the id-idew ritual.

Id-idew is a ritual performed the night before the start of the begnas wherein they will butcher chicken to know if the activity will push through depending on the bile of the material.

Kabunian is the Supreme God of the Igorots.

Kawitan refers to a rooster.

Kesep is the first part of the land preparation activity.

Kopis means that the bile sac is waterless.

Labeg is an omen that foretells something that is either good or bad.

Labey is a type of bird.

Lames refers to the living things that can be gathered from bodies of water that can be eaten by human.

Lapsot means that the bile sac has protruded a little.

Legleg is a ritual that cleanses the people from any uncleanness.

Lokbo is a female pig that had not yet given birth.

Mamasang is a female chicken that has not yet laid eggs.

Mendasay is a prayer for abundant harvest.

Nandosdos is a folktale about how the people got their solibao.

Oboan refers to a female chicken who had layed eggs.

Padang is a stick with leaves on it which is used to ward off visitors from the house or rice fields during family rituals.

Pinmingsan means that the material being used either chicken or pig has laid eggs or gave birth birth.

Pinteng are those spirits of people who died of accidents, war and murder

Pitik is a prayer inviting the ancestors to join the begnas.

Ritualist are the community elders performing the various rituals in the agricultural cycle.

Sika means abundance.

Simlit means the bile sac of the material has wholly protruded.

Tengao is a community holiday wherein no one is allowed to travel and go to the farm.

Tinmengao are those spirits who live in the mountains.

Toway is a wooden bowl.

Wading is a kind of fish that could be gathered on bodies of water.

Wakey is the sowing of rice seedlings

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